



Monticello Archaeology Lab

Nail Lecture

Field School 2026

Nail Anatomy and Manufacturing Types

Wrought Nail



Machine Cut Nail



Wire Nail



Parts of a Nail

Head

Shank

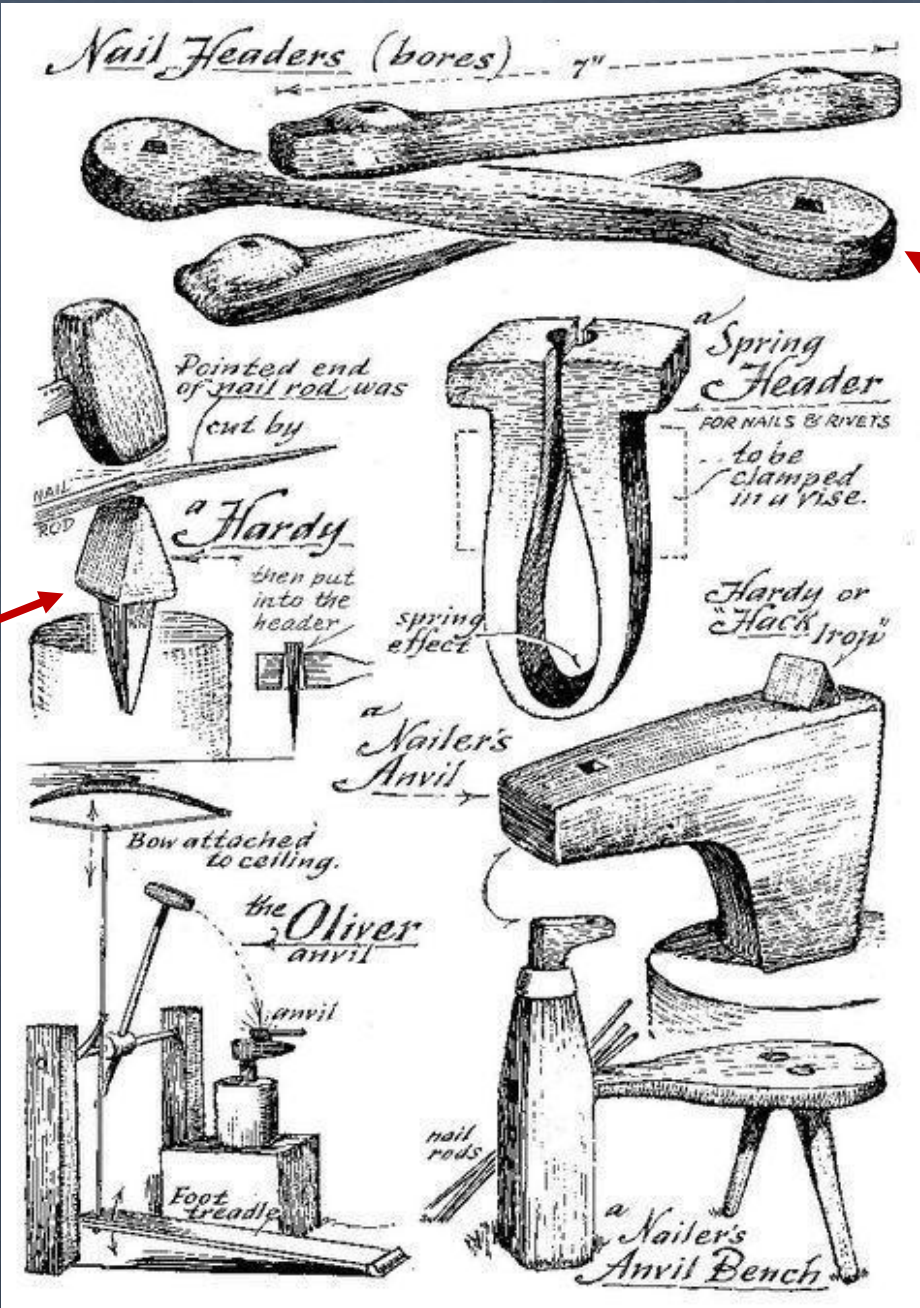
Tip

Nailmaking Tools

Hardy



<https://daacsrc.org/images/2859/edit>



<https://archive.org/details/museumofearlyame0000unse>

Nail Header



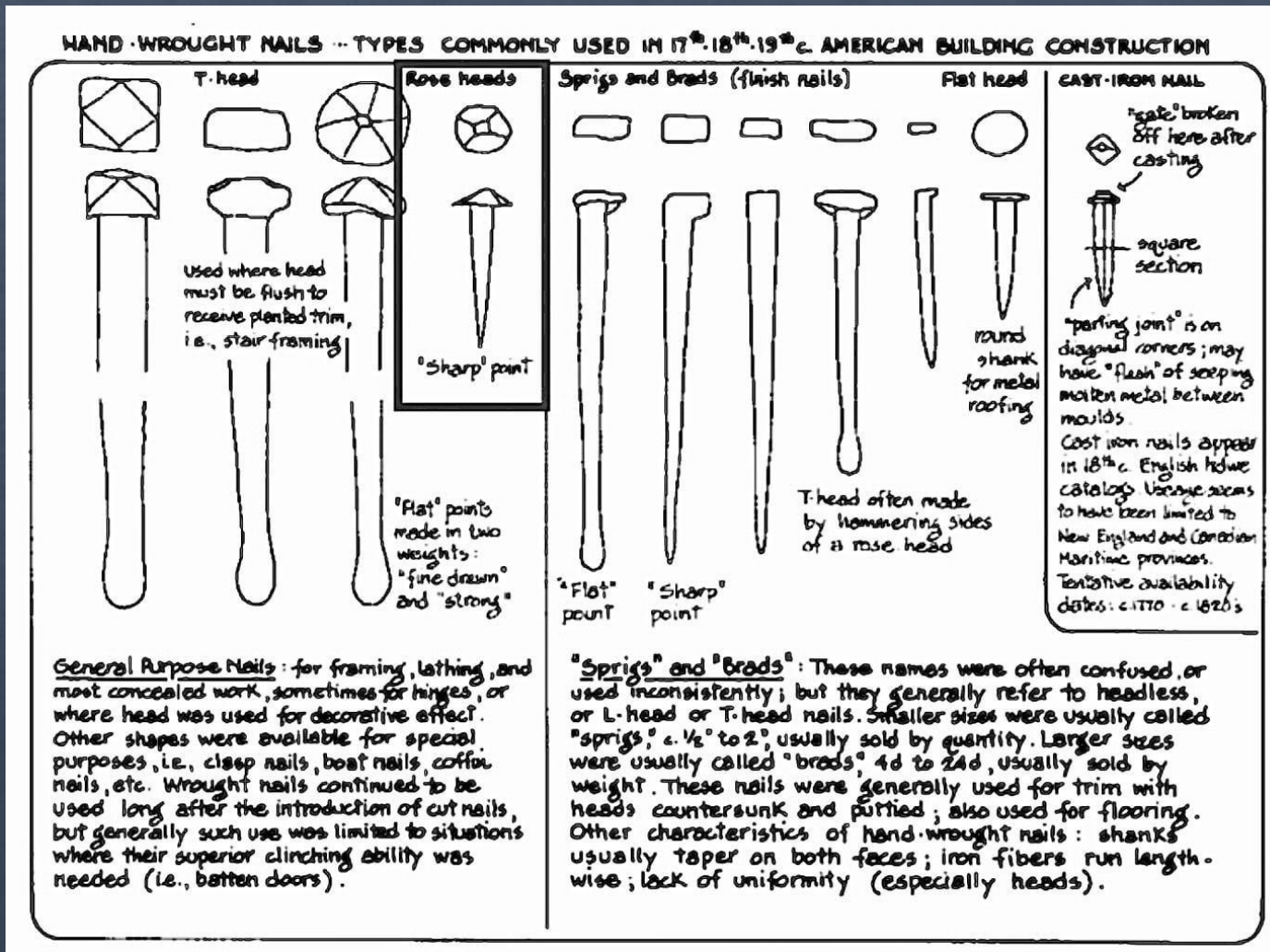
<https://daacsrc.org/images/2861/edit>

Nail rod and nail rod binding



<https://daacsrc.org/images/3129/edit>

Wrought/Forged Nails



<https://daacsrc.org/images/5740/edit>

Hardy and Anvil Wasters

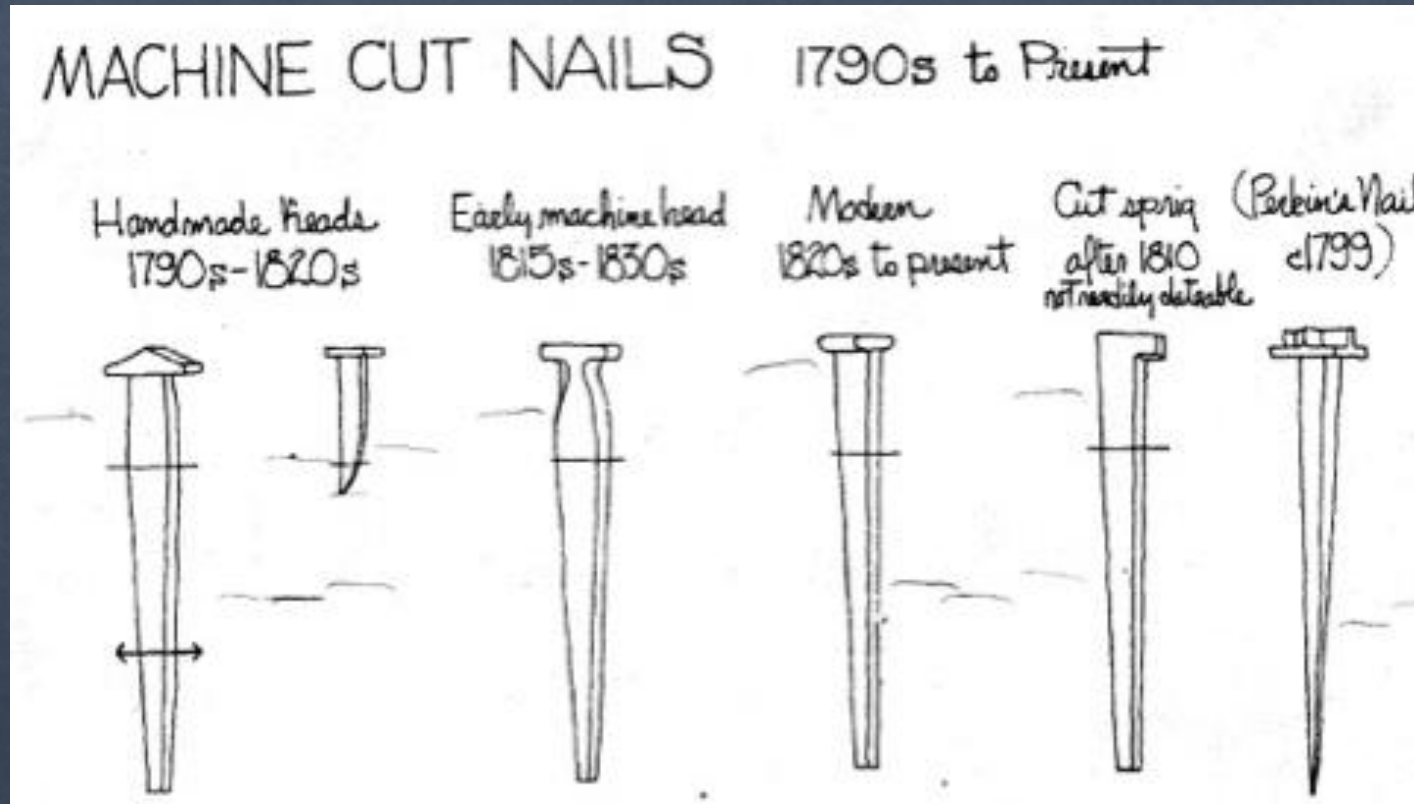
Hardy wasters



Anvil wasters



Machine Cut Nails



<https://www.waybacktimes.com/people/collecting-antique-tools-from-the-march-april-2010-issue-of-the-wt-in-memory-of-jim-ross> Accessed 5/29/26.

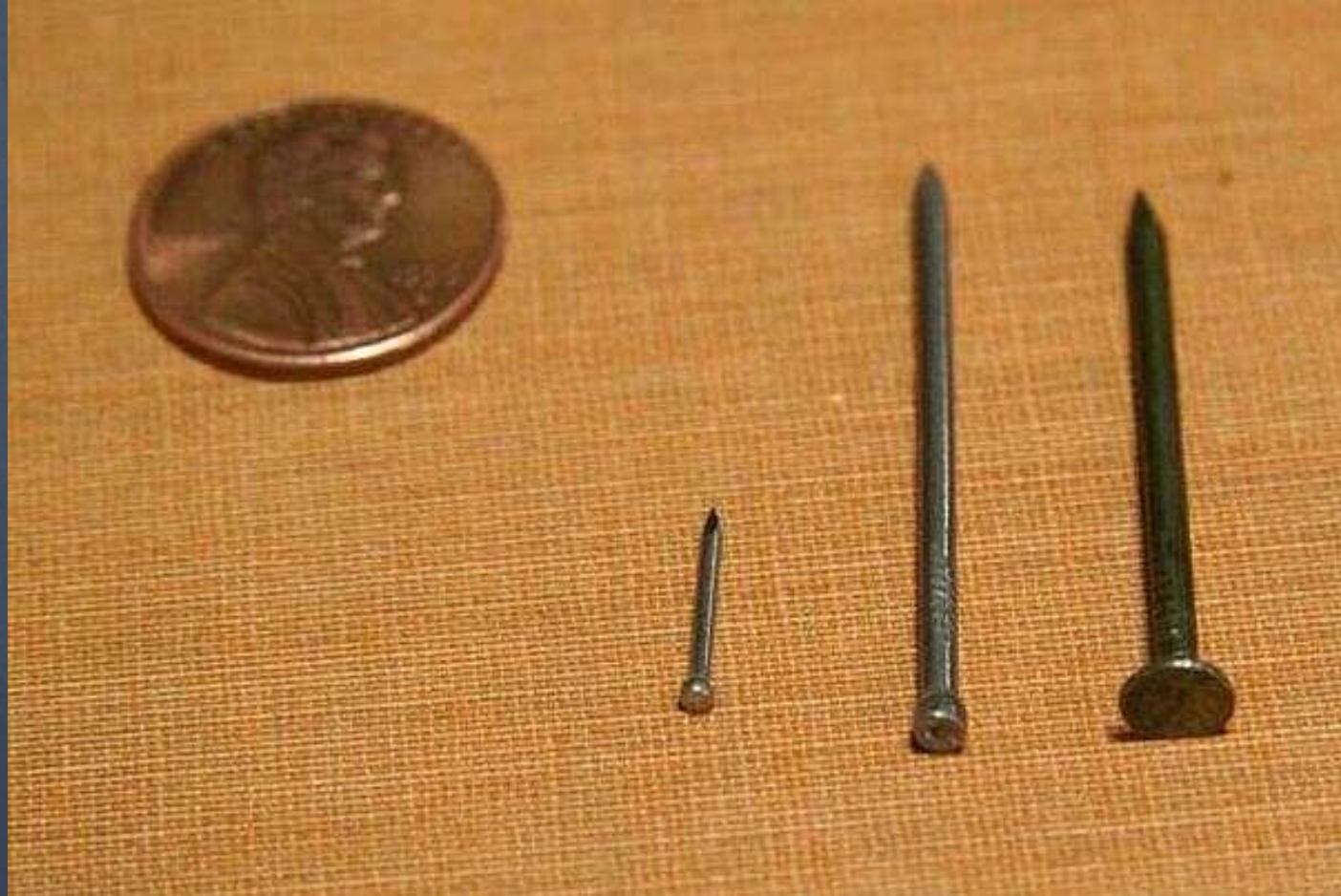


<https://daacsrc.org/images/6680/edit>



https://www.harpgallery.com/blog/the-humble-nail-a-key-to-unlock-the-past/?srsltid=AfmBOopmkTGU5fc90H_G7qTGZ3nruJP0BFcO3Mc7zcp4YcI2Se4AQbNi Accessed 5/29/26

Drawn/Wire Nails



https://www.harpgallery.com/blog/the-humble-nail-a-key-to-unlock-the-past/?srsltid=AfmBOopmkTGU5fc90H_G7qTGZ3nruJP0BFcO3Mc7zcp4YcI2Se4AQbNi Accessed 5/29/26

Nail Modification

“Clinched”



Tip is L-shaped or U-shaped

“Pulled”

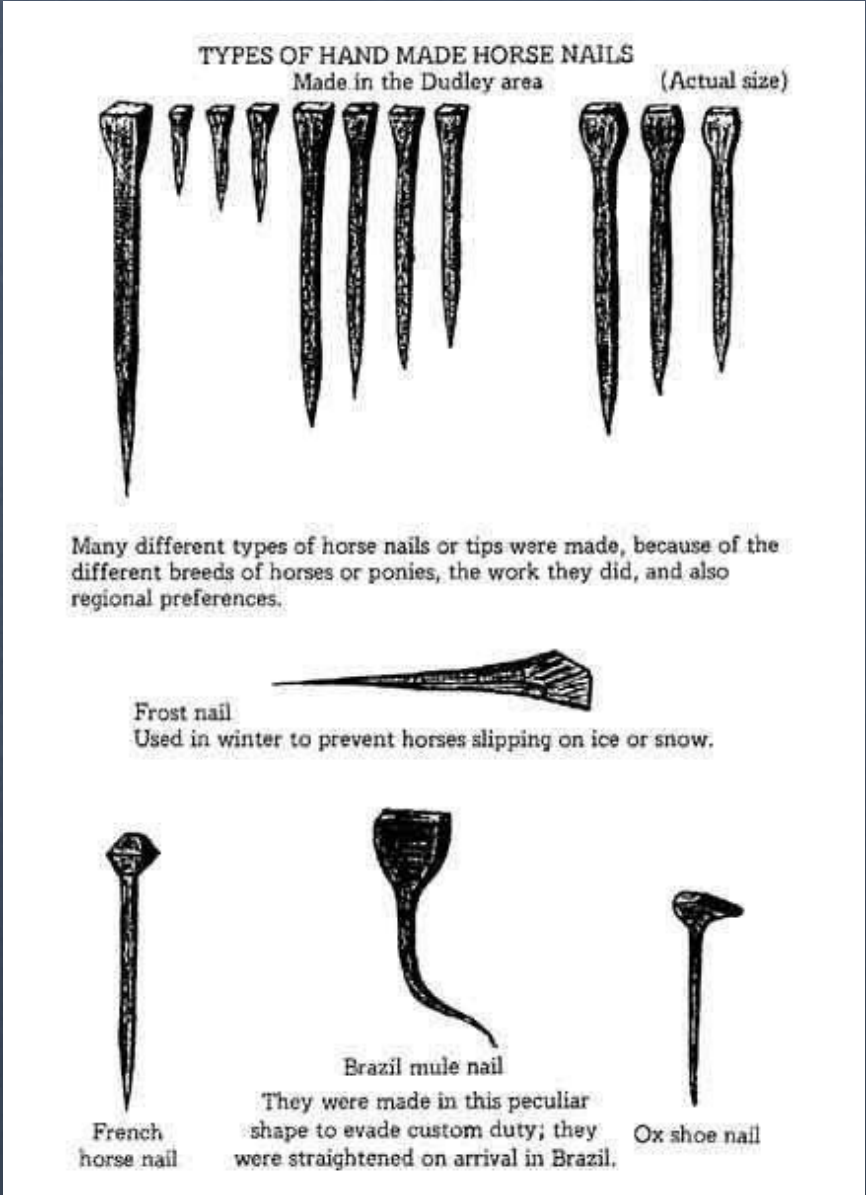


“Bent”



Overall nail J-shaped or C-shaped

Horseshoe Nails



<https://www.sedgleymanor.com/trades/nailmakers2.html> Accessed 5/29/26.



<https://daacsrc.org/images/2565/edit>



<https://daacsrc.org/images/2893/edit>



<https://daacsrc.org/images/2832238/edit>



Nellie



Louie